

GRADE 8

THIRD TERM

HUMANITIES

MASTERNOTE

NATIONAL VALUES AND EDUCATION

“N V E”

CIVIC EDUCATION

SYNOPSIS

WEEKS

TOPICS

- | | |
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| 1&2. | Election meaning types and importance. |
| 3 | Democratic process voting, voter's registration and importance. |
| 4 | Electoral bodies in Nigeria roles. |
| 5 | Free and fair election. |
| 6 | Electoral malpractices in Nigeria meaning, form & causes. |
| 7&8. | Ways of preventing electoral malpractices. |
| 9. | Revision and examinations. |

WEEK 1& 2: ELECTION&VOTERS RESPONSIBILITIES

BEHAVIOURAL OBJECTIVES: Students should be able to:

- Describe the Concept of Election.
- Identify the Concept of a Voter and Voting.
- Highlight the types of Election.
- Mention the Advantages of types of Election.

Concept of Election.

An election can be defined as an act or process of voting for a candidate to represent the people of a country in the various arms of government.

It is also defined as a formal process of selecting a person for public office. It also refers to the means by which the people in a country make political choices by voting for competing candidates or parties.

Election can be described as the process of selecting your choice of candidates of any political parties among contestant for any political office.

Concept of a Voter.

A voter is a person who is eligible to participate in voting. Voters are also referred to as the electorates.

Voting is a process of expressing one's choice of a candidate in an election. Voting exercises come in various ways such as

OPEN BALLOT VOTING: This is the type of voting that is done openly or publicly.

SECRET BALLOT VOTING: This is the system in which voters cast their votes secretly without communicating with others.

OPEN SECRET BALLOT VOTING: The voters cast their votes in secret, in a secluded area attached to the polling booths and bring the thumb printed ballot paper to a ballot box in the open place for all to see.



Types of Elections.

- **DIRECT ELECTION:** This is the process by which voters vote directly to elect their representatives for public office.

Advantages of Direct Election.

- It is highly democratic: It offers citizens the opportunity of choosing their leaders directly through an election.
- Equality of voters: It makes it possible for voters to have equal voting because the principle of one-man vote applies.
- Promotes democracy: Direct election helps in promoting the growth of democracy and political stability.
- Encourages accountability: Direct elections makes elected leaders to be accountable, responsible and responsive.
- Simple to practice: Direct elections are simple to adopt in many societies.

- **INDIRECT ELECTION:** This implies a system whereby eligible voters select representatives who would make the final selection of leaders on their behalf. This involves the use of Electoral College.

Advantages of Indirect Election.

- It is very cheap.
 - It reduces political violence.
 - It reduces electoral malpractice.
 - It enhances quality of law made.
- **ELECTORAL COLLEGE:** This is a body of elected representatives who assist in electing other political or public officers.

Advantages of Electoral College.

- It reduces electoral malpractice.
 - It is less expensive.
 - It produces winners easily.
 - It makes voting very short and easy.
- **BY- ELECTION:** This refers to an election that is conducted to fill a vacant elective post due to recall or resignation or death of an individual holding a given political office.
 - **RUN – OFF ELECTION:** This is an election that is reconducted due to disqualification or election malpractice or annulment of the initial polls or election. It is usually ordered by election tribunal or court.
 - **REFERENDUM/PLEBISCITES:** This is a 'yes' or 'no' vote of the people particularly on law in a given political system. It helps the government in knowing the opinion of people about an ++important issue of national interest or concern.
 - **PRIMARY ELECTION:** This refers to an election conducted within the party to elect the flag bearer of the party.



Exercises:

1. Define Election
2. Mention and explain 4 types of Election
3. Which type of election use yes or no as means of voting.
4. Election is a process in which people vote candidates that would represent their interests in ____.
5. The process of casting votes during election is called ____.
6. Election of credible ____ is responsibility of voters.
7. Formation of new ____ is important for election.
8. In democracy, ultimate power belongs to the
- A. People
- B. Representative
- C. Lawyer
- D. Leader
- 9.

WEEK 3: ELECTION&VOTERS RESPONSIBILITIES CONTD

BEHAVIOURAL OBJECTIVES: Students should be able to:

- State the meaning of voters' registration.

- List and explain the importance of voting.
- Describe voter education.

Meaning of voters' registration.

This is the act of recording voters' information in some official lists. These lists have columns for voter's names, age, sex, address, etc. This registration usually takes place some months before the election. It is only those who are above 18 years and have passed through the registration exercise that are eligible to vote on the Election Day.

Importance of voting.

- **Civic rights:** The citizens exercise this right to give legitimacy to the government in power as their major responsibility.
- **Choice of leaders:** Voting gives citizens the rights to make a choice among the candidates contesting to lead them.
- **Checking of leaders:** Voting affords the electorate the opportunity to check and control the excesses of their leaders during electioneering campaigns.
- **Legitimacy:** Voting gives the leader the power to rule with the consent of the people. That is when a government is voted in power which is legitimate of the majority.
- **Popular participation:** Voting allows every citizen to play active roles in the governance. It enables the citizens the opportunity to challenge the government to work in their interest.
- **Accountability:** Voting makes the leader to be accountable when canvassing for votes, politician is made to give accounts of what they have done. They are therefore held accountable during campaigns.
- **Political consciousness:** Voting enhances the politician to mobilize the electorate and open up ideas and policies of government to them. Hence people become politically conscious. They are aware of various actions and the implications of such.



VOTER EDUCATION

It is the passing of information, materials and programs designed to enlighten people about voting and the electoral process for a particular election.

It involves providing information on who is eligible to vote where and how to register, what type of election can be held and how to file complaints.

It also involves educating voters on concepts such as roles, responsibilities and right of voters, relationship between election and democracy.

The national electoral body in Nigeria is called “Independent National Electoral Commission” [INEC] which is in charge of conducting election at the federal level while the “State Independent Electoral Commission” [SIEC] conduct election for local level at all states.

INEC was established by General Abdul Salam Abubakar in 1998 and conducted the democratic election in 1999. However, the current chairman for INEC is Mamood Yakubu who was appointed by President Muhammadu Buhari on 21st October 2015.

Voter education can be done through the use of posters, direct mailing of voters, street theatre, role play, jingles, social Medias, campaign and rallies.

Exercises:

1. What is the meaning of voter education?
2. “INEC and SIEC” represent what.
3. State 4 importance of voting.
4. Participation in voter’s _____ exercise is a procedure for election.
5. A voter is a person who is ____ to cast vote during general elections.
6. The appropriate age for participating as a voter in Nigeria is _____.
7. Who is the chairperson for INEC?

WEEK 4: QUALIFICATION FOR ELECTION& RESPONSIBILITIES OF A VOTER

BEHAVIOURAL OBJECTIVES: Students should be able to:

- Outline the qualifications for election.
- Discuss the responsibilities of voters.
- Identify voters’ rights.

Qualifications for election.

- **AGE:** You must be 18years and above to vote in Nigeria election. Those seeking election as president, members of national assemblies or state governors must be 35years above while candidates for state house of representatives must be 30years above.

- **CITIZENSHIP:** You must be a Nigerian citizen for you to seek any political post.
- **MUST BE A MEMBER OF REGISTERED POLITICAL PARTY:** The person seeking elective post must be a member of one well known political party in the country before people will vote for that person.
- **EDUCATIONAL QUALIFICATION:** In Nigeria, the minimum needed qualification to be voted into the parliament is West African School Certificate “WASC”.
- **CRIME FREE:** To vie for an elective post in Nigeria the candidate must not have any criminal record. The person must not be an ex- convict i.e. a person that has been imprisoned for any criminal offence.
- **SANITY:** A person contesting for election must not be in sane.
- **TAX PAYMENT:** The candidate must be ready to provide the evidence of tax payment over a period of time.

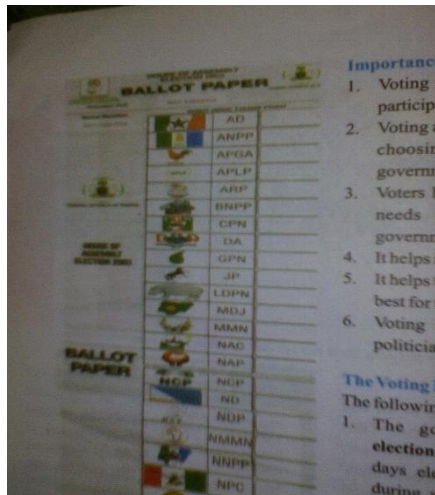
Responsibilities of voters.

- Voters must possess a valid permanent voters’ card “PVC”.
- Must respect the privacy of other voters.
- Must treat electoral officials with respect also.
- Must know the location of his or her polling station and its hours of operation.
- Must bring proper identification to the polling station.
- Must report any problems or violations of election laws to the supervisor of election.
- Must make sure that his or her complete ballot is correct before leaving the polling station.
- Must familiarize him or herself with candidates.
- Must participate in election by coming out to vote.
- Must follow instructions concerning voting procedures.
- Must follow all federal and state voting laws.

Voters’ Rights.

- Right to vote if they register.

- Right to ask questions on election process or procedure.
- Right to preview a sample ballot before voting.
- Right to vote in privacy and freedom from coercion or intimidation.
- Right to receive assistance if you are blind, have a physical disability or have an inability to read English or any Nigerian languages.



Importance

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**SMART DRAGON
BALLOT
EXPERT**



Exercises:

1. Highlight five qualifications for election.

2. Enumerate five responsibilities of a voter.
3. Mention three voters' rights.



Fig 1

4. The image above fig1 is called ____.



Fig 2

5. The above image is called ____ and use for 6. ____

WEEK 5: PROCEDURE FOR VOTING& IMPORTANCE OF ELECTION

BEHAVIOURAL OBJECTIVES: Students should be able to:

- Identify the procedure for voting.
- Explain each procedure for voting.
- Describe the importance of election.

The Procedure for voting.

The procedure for voting is as follow:

- **Registration of voters:** It the first stage where all citizens above 18years of age will go to the appropriate places to register their names and other data with the registration officers sent by the electoral body which is done at every constituency in the country.

- **Verification of voters' names:** The electoral body will display the voters' registers for those that had registered to verify their names in order to correct any mistake the polling agents must have made and permanent voters' card will be given.
- **Accreditation:** This happens on election day before voting begins where voters' come very early by 8am to 12noon to their polling stations to ascertain their names using the P.V.C. card reader which will enable the electoral officers have ideas of the number of voters expected on their list.
- **Voting proper:** Voting proper starts after accreditation from 12:30pm to 4:30pm. At this stage each accredited voter will queue [line up], collect ballot papers to cast their votes one by one in the polling booth provided for you to thumb print on the ballot papers and come out to drop it in the ballot boxes provided.
- **Counting of votes:** After the casting of votes by the electorates, the electoral officers will take the ballot boxes containing the ballot papers and start taking out the ballot papers one by one and counting aloud until the ballot boxes are empty in secret ballot system while in the open balloting the electoral officers will move straight to the voters who have lined up in front of their interested candidate and start counting.
- **Announcement of election results:** This is the last stage which determines who wins the election. It is at this stage that the results of the votes cast are announced and this is done in the presence of all voters. It takes place at each polling station all over the country, depending on the posts being contested for. It is this result from each polling station that will be added up to determine who, among the candidates eventually wins the election.



Importance of election.

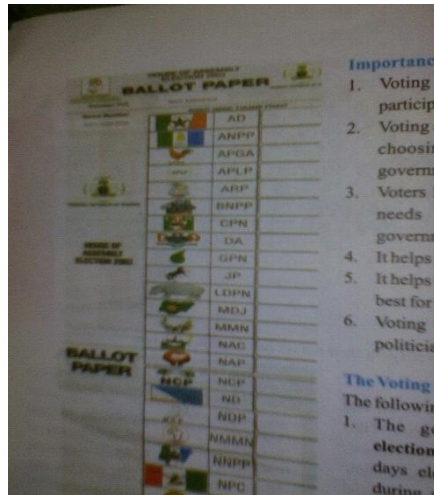
- **It provides opportunity for choosing leaders:** Election gives the people in a country the opportunity for choosing their leaders into different political offices like the president, governor, legislators and so on.
- **It makes change of government easy and peaceful:** Election provides an opportunity for the masses to peacefully remove bad government from office and ensures peaceful change of government to another.
- **It promotes democracy:** Election is one of the pillars of democracy. Regular free and fair elections help in sustaining democracy in any country.
- **It checks the excesses of leaders:** Leaders with oppressive and tyrannical tendencies tend to change knowing fully well that the electorates may not vote them in again if they do not rule effectively.
- **It provides opportunity for political education:** Election provides a forum for political parties to give political education to the masses. It is usually done through campaigns where parties unfold their manifestoes to the masses.
- **It provides opportunity for citizens to participate in government:** Election gives the masses the opportunity of participating in government by casting votes for the candidates of their choice. It is also the public opinion on an issue.
- **Legitimacy into government:** Legitimacy is the legal and political backing which government has to operate in a state. Any government not elected is not legitimate to determine the faith of the people.
- GRADE 9 CIVIC EDUCATION











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1. The Registration of voters means _____
2. Accreditation of voters means _____



3. The image above is used to ____



4. The above image shows ____ is going on.

5. The venue place where people cast their votes is called ____

WEEK 6: ELECTORAL MALPRACTICES

BEHAVIOURAL OBJECTIVES: Students should be able to:

- Explain the concept electoral malpractices.
- Enumerate the forms or types of electoral malpractices.
- Describe the forms or types of electoral malpractices.

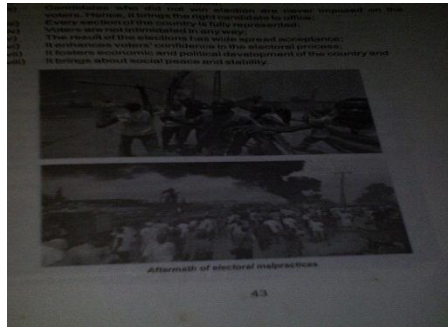
Meaning of the concept electoral malpractices

Electoral malpractice can be defined as an illegal interference with electoral process. It is also called electoral fraud or voters' fraud.

Electoral malpractices are ways of influencing elections in dishonest way, so as to get the results that one wants by all means.

Forms or Types of Electoral Malpractices

- **Use of fake ballot papers:** When fake ballot papers are used for casting vote for multiple voting so that a particular candidate can win the election. This leads to vote manipulation making the wrong candidate win the election thereby robbing the electorates of their rights choice of leadership.
- **Artificial scarcity of electoral materials:** Electoral malpractices also involves deliberate denial of the electorates of voting materials such as ballot boxes, ballot papers etc. to frustrate them. This is done in areas where a particular candidate has strong support and no other means can be used to fight him.
- **Underage voting:** This is a situation where youths below constitutionally approved voting age are made to vote. This could be done in areas where the party has few legal voters and more youths under voting age.
- **Thuggery and intimidation:** There are situations where thugs are hired by political parties to intimidate people by coming out with dangerous weapons like cutlass to scare electorates away from voting.
- **Financial inducement:** Voters may be given money or other rewards to vote for a particular candidate though this may be against their choice. Vote buying may be done indirectly when politicians bribe pastors or imams to tell their followers to vote for a particular candidate.
- **Fake manifestoes:** Parties may give fake manifesto to woo voters to their side. At the end of election these promises will not be fulfilled.
- **Disenfranchisement:** Electoral malpractice can manipulate the information about the electorates which render them unqualified for the election.
- **Rigging:** This is the skilful tampering of the results of an election in order to favour a candidate over the other. In some places where elections were not held for one reason or the other election results are declared.
- **Unlawful detention:** This is a system of malpractices in which the opposing candidates or strong members or supporters of a party are detained for flimsy excuses, until the voting exercise is over. This allowed to favour candidate or political parties to engage in any kind of malpractices they wish to perpetrate.
- **Mis – recording of votes:** This normally happens to people who need assistance of others for voting for instance, the blind or illiterate electorates. Those assisting them may lead them to vote for a wrong candidate.



Exercises:

1. Discuss the following forms of electoral malpractice

- [i] Underage voting
- [ii] Financial inducement
- [iii] Thuggery and intimidation

4. Describe electoral malpractice.

5. Use of fake ballot papers mean ____



6. The person carrying something and running mean ____ during election.

7. Artificial scarcity of electoral materials can be described as _____

WEEK 7: ELECTORAL MALPRACTICES CAUSES&CONSEQUENCES

BEHAVIOURAL OBJECTIVES: Students should be able to:

- Discuss the causes of electoral malpractices.
- State the consequences of electoral malpractices.
- Explain the consequences of electoral malpractices mentioned.

Causes of electoral malpractices

- **Crave for power:** Many politicians engage in electoral malpractice because they want political power at all cost. Unfortunately, such people do not perform when they win the election but rather engage in looting the government treasury.
- **Poverty:** It is easy for politicians to buy electorates with money or materials such as food items, clothes, shoes and so on. Many people will not mind selling their votes once their present needs are met.
- **Lack of political education:** Many electorates are easily deceived by politicians because they are ignorant of their rights and responsibilities during election. Politicians play on the ignorance of the electorates to manipulate the election.
- **Bribery and corruption:** Some electoral officials do connive with politicians to manipulate election. Once the politicians have bribed them with money, they tend to overlook whatever is happening to the ballot boxes and the ballot papers.
- **Inadequate planning:** If the electoral body does not prepare adequately for the elections, they will create opportunity for electoral malpractice. For instance, where government does not provide enough policemen at polling station, thugs will have free day stuffing the ballot boxes with votes of their candidates.

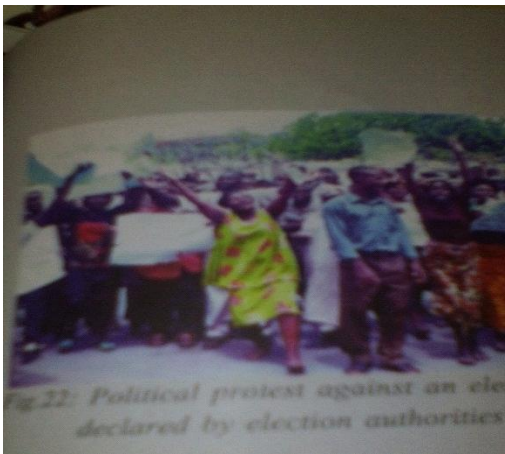
- **Late arrival of materials at voting centres:** Late arrival of materials will cause lateness in voting and if voting extends into the night it will be easy for unpatriotic elements to perpetrate all kinds of electoral malpractice.
- **Influence of the party in power:** There are times when the party in power indirectly dictates to the electoral commission. There could be order from above to upturn results of election to favour the candidates of the party in power.
- **Lack of stiff punishment for offenders:** If the government does not give severe punishment to those engaging in electoral malpractice to act as a deterrent to others the heinous act may continue unchecked. The perpetrators will be encouraged to continue since they know there will be little or no punishment.

Consequences or effects of electoral malpractice.

- **Bad leadership:** Electoral malpractice allows wrong people to be in government. This people may be inexperienced, visionless and corrupt which will lead to bad leadership.
- **Riots and chaos:** Electoral malpractice could lead to riot, violence, burning of houses and destruction of properties. Nigeria has experienced all these in almost every general election conducted so far.
- **Loss of lives and property:** Many have lost their lives, cars buildings, parts of their body to riots and protests over election results which made angry electorate to be violent by destroying winning party properties.
- **Bad image:** Electoral malpractice paints the country bad internationally. The nation is seen as a corrupt nation. The leaders cannot earn the respect of nations where democracy is successfully thriving. Our leaders would be seen as crooks who are not fit to rule the country.
- **Loss of interest in voting:** where election results are always manipulated, electorates may develop apathy towards voting in subsequent elections. No amount of persuasion on the part of the government will make them vote.
- **Military intervention:** Where electoral malpractice becomes the order of the day or causing civil unrest, bad leadership and political problems, the military may see the need to come back. This will bring a serious setback to the growth of democracy in

Nigeria. Under the military, all democratic institutions will be scrapped and the military will rule by decree and not by the wish of the people.

- **Enmity:** Electoral malpractices have in many ways caused enmity among Nigeria citizens. It has broken many homes and has plated hatred of no cure in the hearts of many husbands and wives, bosom friends, families and relations.
- **Lack of smooth transition:** Electoral malpractices make the citizen not to believe in the next coming government since they will always get the power by all means even at the welfare of the people which does not encourage citizens to sacrifice for the country.



Exercises:

1. Mention five causes of electoral malpractices.

Describe the following consequences of electoral malpractice.

2. Bad image
3. Loss of interest in voting.
4. Loss of lives and properties.
5. Bad leadership.

WEEK 8: SOLUTIONS TO ELECTORAL MALPRACTICES

BEHAVIOURAL OBJECTIVES: Students should be able to:

- Itemise the possible solutions to the electoral malpractices.

- Describe the solutions mentioned above.

Solutions to electoral malpractices.

The following steps should be taken by the government to prevent electoral malpractice in Nigeria.

- **Non- interference in electoral matters:** The government in power should not in any way influence the activities of the electoral commission before, during and after election. The government in power should be sincere and impartial in electoral matters before, during and after election.
- **Impartiality of judiciary:** The judiciary should play the role of defender of democracy before, during and after elections. Cases of electoral malpractice should be treated with urgency, seriousness, and impartiality. There should be no sacred cow when judgment is to be passed. Anyone involved should be dealt with to act as a deterrent to others in future elections.
- **Education of electorate:** The government agency in charge of orientation should do its best to organize programmes that will educate the electorates of their rights and responsibilities before, during and after elections. They should be informed of electoral procedures and what to do in case of any intimidation or harassment from any quarters.
- **Adequate security:** The government should make enough security agents available at every polling station to protect the electoral officials, electoral materials and the voters.
- **Re- orientation of politicians:** Nigeria politicians should be given orientation so that their attitude to election could change. The love for the nation should be paramount in their hearts rather than their selfish desire for position they could use to loot the treasury. If they have a good attitude, election will not be a do- or – die affair and electoral malpractice would be reduced.
- **Proper planning:** Electoral commission that coordinates election should do a proper planning of the election so that there will not be loopholes for politicians or their agents to hijack the election. Enough money should be made available for provision of electoral materials like ballot boxes, ballot papers and so on.
- **Introduction of civic education in primary and secondary schools:** The reintroduction of civic education and primary in post-primary institutions is a very good idea. It is a right policy to solving electoral problems in Nigeria. It will build in our youth's positive attitude towards election as future party leaders, candidates or electorates.

Exercises:

- Explain the following solutions to the electoral malpractice
 - [i] Adequate security.
 - [ii] Education of electorate.
 - [iii] Proper planning.